

PMOS™

RECOVERY TOOLKIT

12 ready-to-use templates for ERP & transformation program recovery

Project Recovery · Governance · Leadership · Delivery

Project Management Operating System
Behavioral Diagnosis & Recovery for ERP and Transformation Programs

How to use this toolkit

This toolkit turns a PMOS diagnosis into action. Each template is designed to be opened, filled in, and used in a real program within the same week. They are deliberately lean — a recovery program does not need more documentation, it needs the right documentation used well.

THE FOUR CATEGORIES MAP TO THE FOUR THINGS THAT FAIL

- PROJECT RECOVERY — for when the program is already off track and needs a structured turnaround.
- GOVERNANCE — for when decisions, risks, and accountability have become unclear.
- LEADERSHIP — for re-engaging sponsors and steering committees and giving them what they need to act.
- DELIVERY — for protecting go-live and cutover when the pressure is highest.

Start with the template that matches your primary PMOS pattern. If your primary pattern is Hero Dependency or Death By Governance, begin with Project Recovery and Governance. If it is Nobody Wants To Decide, begin with the Decision Log and Steering Committee Pack. If it is Silent Resistance, begin with the Stakeholder Recovery Plan and Go-Live Checklist.

CATEGORY 1

Project Recovery

1 • Recovery Playbook

Use when: the program is off track and you need a structured, time-boxed turnaround rather than incremental fixes.

The 5-step recovery sequence

1. **STABILISE** (Days 1–5): Stop the bleeding. Freeze new scope. Identify the two or three things that, if they fail this week, end the program. Protect those first.
2. **DIAGNOSE** (Days 3–10): Run the PMOS diagnostic if you have not. Confirm the primary behavioral pattern. Map the critical-path dependencies and the people who hold them.
3. **CONTRACT** (Days 5–14): Agree a recovery mandate with the sponsor — what you will deliver, what authority you need, and what you will stop doing. Get it in writing.
4. **EXECUTE** (Days 14–60): Run the 30/60/90 recovery plan. Re-distribute hero load, collapse governance, install decision ownership. Measure weekly.
5. **REINFORCE** (Days 60–90): Lock in the new behaviors. Re-run the diagnostic. Any pattern still Critical after 90 days needs external support.

Recovery mandate — fill in

Element	Your program
Recovery objective (one sentence)	
Sponsor / decision owner	
Authority granted to recovery lead	
What we will STOP doing	
Success measure at day 30	
Success measure at day 90	

2 · Recovery Checklist

Use when: you need a fast, honest read on whether recovery is actually progressing. Score weekly. Anything in the right column is a red flag.

Checkpoint	On track	Off track
Scope is frozen and protected	Yes	Still expanding
Primary PMOS pattern is named and owned	Yes	Unclear
Sponsor has a recurring decision slot	Yes	Ad hoc only
Critical knowledge is documented, not in one head	Yes	Single point of failure
Open decisions have named owners + dates	Yes	Drifting
Governance forums each produce decisions	Yes	Status only
Top 3 risks are visible to leadership	Yes	Buried
The team can say what 'done' looks like	Yes	Ambiguous
Go-live date is credible, not aspirational	Yes	Hope-based

3 · Executive Escalation Framework

Use when: an issue exceeds your authority to resolve and needs a decision from above — without it sounding like you have lost control.

The escalation structure (use this order)

6. SITUATION — one sentence on what is happening, in plain language.
7. IMPACT — what it costs if unresolved, in time and money. Be specific.
8. OPTIONS — two or three real choices, not a single demand.
9. RECOMMENDATION — the one you would pick and why.
10. DECISION NEEDED BY — a real date, and what happens if it slips.

Escalation template — fill in

Field	Content
Issue title	
Situation (1 sentence)	
Impact if unresolved	
Option A	
Option B	
Recommendation	
Decision needed by	
Escalated to	

CATEGORY 2

Governance

4 • RAID Log

Use when: risks, assumptions, issues, and dependencies are being tracked in people's heads or scattered across emails. The RAID log makes them visible and owned.

Risks

ID	Risk description	Likelihood	Impact	Owner	Mitigation

Assumptions

ID	Assumption	Validated?	Owner

Issues

ID	Issue (live now)	Severity	Owner	Action

Dependencies

ID	Dependency	Owner	Needed by	Status

5 · Decision Log

Use when: decisions are being re-litigated because nobody recorded them, or when 'Nobody Wants To Decide' is your primary pattern. A visible decision log creates ownership and stops re-debate.

ID	Decision required	Owner (one name)	Date needed	Decision made	Date closed

Rule: every row has exactly one name in the Owner column. Not a committee. Not a role. One person who is accountable for the decision being made by the date needed.

6 · Governance Health Checklist

Use when: you suspect governance has become overhead rather than control ('Death By Governance'). Run the kill-test on every recurring forum.

The kill-test — for each governance forum, answer:

Forum / meeting	Produced a decision last month?	Right people attend?	Keep / Merge / Kill

Governance principles to restore

- Every recurring forum must produce decisions, not just status. If it only reports, it can be an email.
- Maximum two signatures on any approval. Three or more means the chain is redesigned.
- Every meeting has a named decision-owner who can close items in the room.
- Status reporting is consolidated — one source, not one per audience.

CATEGORY 3

Leadership

7 · Steering Committee Pack

Use when: you need to brief a steering committee in a way that drives decisions rather than absorbs an hour of status. This is the agenda structure that works.

The 30-minute steering agenda

Time	Item	Outcome
0–5 min	Headline: where we are, in one slide (RAG + the one number that matters)	Shared situational awareness
5–15 min	Decisions needed today (from the Decision Log)	Closed decisions, named owners
15–22 min	Top 3 risks and what we need from this committee	Risk mitigation authorised
22–28 min	Recovery progress vs the 30/60/90 plan	Confidence or course-correction
28–30 min	Actions and owners confirmed	Everyone leaves knowing their job

What NOT to do: do not walk the committee through every workstream. They do not need status; they need to make the two or three decisions only they can make.

8 · Executive Talking Points

Use when: you need to brief a sponsor or board on a struggling program without sounding like you have lost control — or worse, like everything is fine when it is not.

Opening — frame the problem, not the symptoms

“Our status reporting is accurate but incomplete. I have run a behavioral diagnostic on the program. It surfaced patterns our standard reporting does not capture, and two of them need a decision from this group today.”

The primary finding

“Our primary risk is [PATTERN], scoring [X]/100. In plain terms: [one-sentence consequence]. This is a structural risk, not a staffing issue, and it is the most common cause of late-stage failure in programs like ours.”

The financial case

“Our modelled exposure from delay, remediation and unrealised benefits is approximately [FIGURE]. The recovery actions I am proposing cost a fraction of that and can be running this week. The question is not whether we can afford to act — it is whether we can afford not to.”

The ask

“I need two things today: a recurring decision slot with the sponsor, and authority to [collapse X governance forums / re-distribute the critical-path workload]. I will report measurable progress at the next steering.”

9 · Stakeholder Recovery Plan

Use when: adoption is failing quietly ('Silent Resistance') — the system changed but the behavior did not. Map who is resisting, why, and what moves them.

Stakeholder / group	Current stance	Why (the real reason)	What moves them	Owner

Stance legend

- CHAMPION — actively advocating. Protect and amplify them.
- COMPLIANT — going through the motions. At risk of reverting. Reinforce.
- PASSIVE — quietly using the old way. The biggest adoption risk. Engage directly.
- RESISTANT — openly opposed. Often the most honest signal — understand why.

CATEGORY 4

Delivery

10 · Go-Live Readiness Checklist

Use when: 6–8 weeks before cutover. Go-live readiness is a behavioral outcome, not a completion percentage. These checkpoints test whether the organisation — not just the system — is ready.

Readiness checkpoint	Ready?	Owner	Evidence
Business owns the process, not just the project team			
Key individuals are not single points of failure			
Decisions are being made at delivery pace			
Shadow processes have been audited and addressed			
Cutover plan is rehearsed, not just written			
Rollback plan exists and has been tested			
Hypercare team and escalation path are named			
Training effectiveness measured, not just delivered			
Data migration validated against real transactions			
Go / no-go decision owner and criteria are agreed			

11 · Cutover Checklist

Use when: planning and running the cutover window itself. Sequence, ownership, and go/no-go gates — hour by hour.

Step	Task	Owner	Planned time	Done	Go/No-Go gate
1	Final data extract from legacy				No
2	System freeze on legacy				No
3	Data migration executed				No
4	Migration validation (reconciliation)				GATE 1
5	Integration / interface verification				No
6	Smoke test of critical transactions				GATE 2
7	Business validation sign-off				GATE 3
8	Go-live communication issued				No
9	Hypercare team active				No

At each GATE: a named owner makes an explicit go / no-go call against pre-agreed criteria. No gate is passed by silence or assumption.

12 · Risk Mitigation Tracker

Use when: you have identified risks (via the RAID log or PMOS risk forecast) and need to track that mitigation is actually happening — not just listed.

Risk	Severity	Mitigation action	Owner	Due	Status

Status legend

- NOT STARTED — mitigation agreed but no action taken. If severity is high, this is itself a risk.
- IN PROGRESS — action underway, on track.
- BLOCKED — action stalled. Escalate using the Executive Escalation Framework (template 3).
- CLOSED — risk mitigated or accepted with sign-off.

Using the toolkit with your PMOS diagnosis

Each template maps to the PMOS behavioral patterns. Use your diagnostic report to decide where to start:

If your primary pattern is...	Start with these templates
Hero Dependency™	Recovery Playbook, Recovery Checklist, Go-Live Checklist
Death By Governance™	Governance Checklist, Decision Log, Steering Committee Pack
Nobody Wants To Decide™	Decision Log, Executive Escalation Framework, Steering Pack
Silent Resistance™	Stakeholder Recovery Plan, Go-Live Checklist, RAID Log
Builder Culture™ (weak)	Recovery Playbook, Steering Committee Pack

PMOS™

Project Management Operating System · Behavioral Diagnosis & Recovery

Developed by a practitioner with 17 years of ERP implementation, transformation and program delivery experience.